AEP FROM ZERO • PART 2 • SPEAK TO YOUR CUSTOMER (AJO)

EPISODE 23

AJO Frequency Capping, Quiet Hours, Suppression

AJO frequency capping explained from zero: how business rules, rule sets and the GLOBAL RULE SET work in Adobe Journey Optimizer, and why a cap applied per journey is not a cap at all. Bloom sets a limit of two marketing emails per profile per week, learns that a Draft rule set protects nobody, that caps reset in UTC and apply to proofs, and sets quiet hours in each customer's time zone with queue or discard. Then the suppression list is separated from unsubscribes and consent, the

Previously: offers in, and a worrying headline

- Last time: three approved offers, one decision policy
- Comeback above Early Access; Free Shipping fallback
- Then a rival brand spammed its customers
- Anjali: can that happen to us?
- Today: business rules, quiet hours, suppression

KEY IDEA

Bloom's offers now live in one decision policy. Today Anjali asks whether Bloom could spam its customers, and Divya builds the guardrails that say no.

Can that happen to us?

- Bloom Welcome v1: live since relaunch Monday
- Cart Rescue v1: built to catch abandoned carts
- Bloom Win-Back: about to go to Lapsed 90
- Each one makes sense on its own
- Nobody counted emails per person per week

KEY IDEA

Each Bloom journey and campaign makes sense on its own. Nobody had yet asked how many emails one person receives from all of them in a week.

Business rules: two kinds of rule set

Rule set	What it limits	Rules inside
Channel rule set	Messages per person	Channel Capping, Quiet Hours
Journey rule set	Journeys per person	Entries, concurrent journeys

Journey Optimizer: Administration, Business rules

KEY IDEA

Under Administration, Business rules, rule sets hold the guardrails. Channel rule sets limit messages per person; Journey rule sets limit journeys.

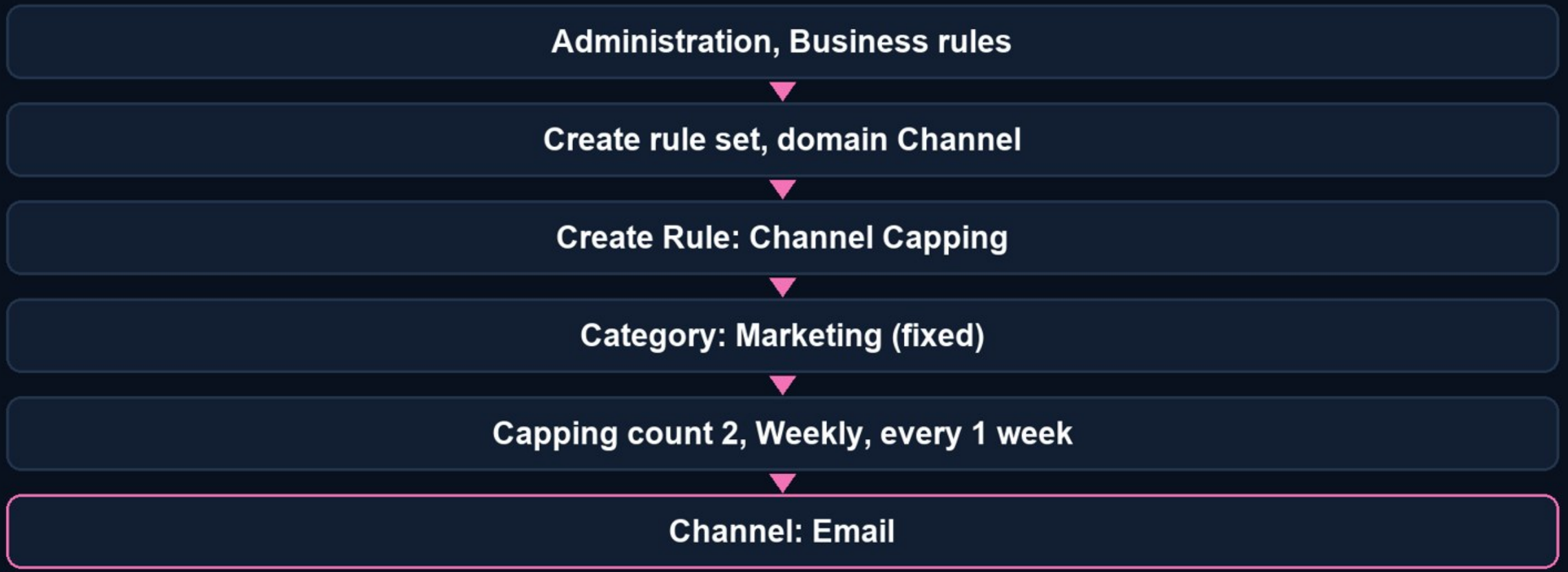
Per-journey capping is not capping

- Count: at most 2 emails
- Period: per week
- Channel: Email
- Category: Marketing
- Scope: every marketing message, per profile
- Two used to be the schedule; now it is the ceiling

KEY IDEA

A customer in five journeys can still get five messages. Bloom agrees one rule per person first: at most two marketing emails per profile per week.

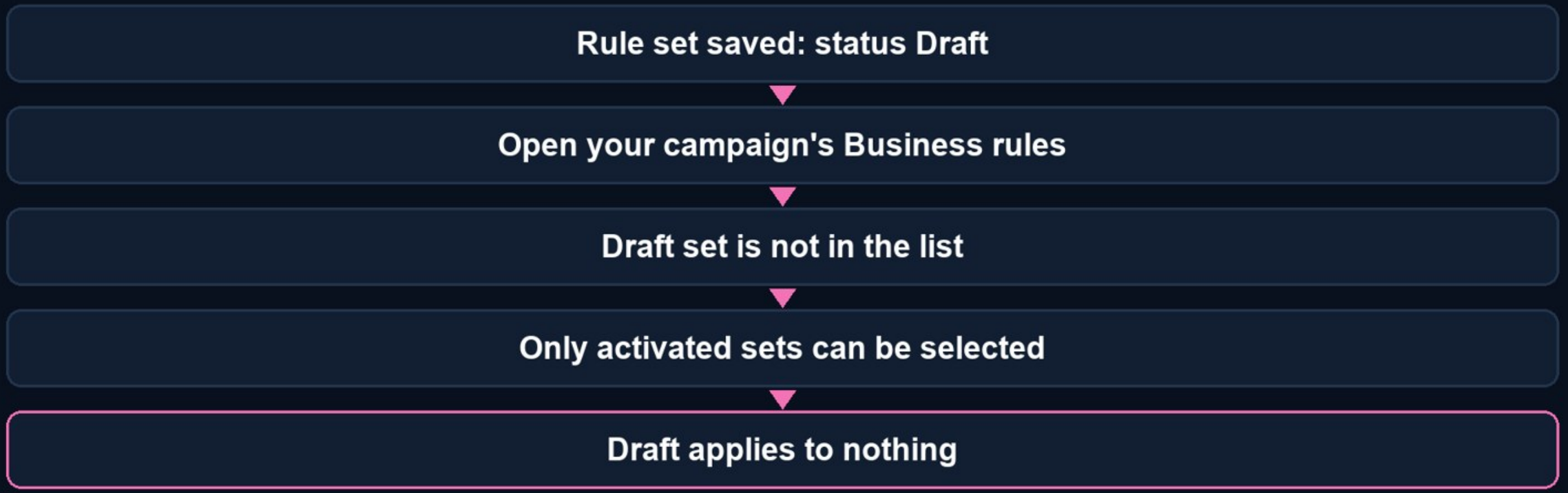
How frequency capping works in AJO



KEY IDEA

A Channel Capping rule sets the count, the reset frequency and the channel. Its category is Marketing, and a message counts once it is delivered.

A Draft rule set protects nobody



KEY IDEA

Kavya's rule set was saved, correct and still Draft. A Draft rule set applies to nothing, and only activated sets can be selected.

Global or selected: where a rule set applies

Where the cap lives	What it covers
Custom set, still Draft	Nothing: Draft applies to nothing
Active custom set	Only the actions that select it
Active custom set, on every action	Every message, if nobody forgets
GLOBAL RULE SET	All messages, no selecting needed

KEY IDEA

The GLOBAL RULE SET applies to all messages. A custom rule set applies only where it is selected, on a campaign or a journey action, once activated.

Caps, proofs and the UTC reset

Question	Answer
Do caps apply to proofs?	Yes: a capped test profile gets nothing
Is there an error?	No: the proof just never arrives
When do weekly caps reset?	Saturday, one second before midnight UTC
In India, that is	Sunday, a little before 5:30 AM
Does Simulation apply caps?	No: caps and quiet hours are not applied

KEY IDEA

Caps apply to proofs, so a capped test profile silently gets nothing. Counters reset in UTC, and Simulation applies no caps at all.

Quiet hours: the customer's clock

- Nine AM server time is three AM for somebody
- Quiet Hours: a rule type in a Channel rule set
- Weekly or custom dates, up to 5 periods
- Customer's local time zone, or a fixed one
- Queue message or Discard message
- Queued more than 7 days: discarded

KEY IDEA

Quiet hours hold back marketing messages during set periods, in the customer's time zone or a fixed one. You choose to queue them or discard them.

Suppression list versus unsubscribe

	Suppression list	Consent (unsubscribe)
A matter of	Deliverability	Permission
Caused by	Bounces, complaints, by hand	The customer saying no
Lives in	Channels, Email settings	Consent on the profile
Example at Bloom	A hard-bounced address	Ananya: no email consent

KEY IDEA

The suppression list holds bounces and spam complaints, a deliverability matter. An unsubscribe is consent on the profile, a permission matter.

Consent is a state, not a checkbox

- Consent has a source, a timestamp, a scope, a lifecycle
- Stored on the profile, enforced in the audience rule
- Allowed list: a separate, test-only guard
- It limits test mail in non-production sandboxes
- Deactivated means nothing stops a real send

KEY IDEA

Consent has a source, a timestamp, a scope and a lifecycle. The allowed list is a different thing: a test-only guard for non-production sandboxes.

The Transactional loophole

Email type	Opt-outs	Use it for
Marketing	Respected	Offers, win-back, newsletters
Transactional	Overridden	Receipts, service notices
Rule of thumb	If it sells	It is Marketing

List unsubscribe: Mailto plus a one-click link

KEY IDEA

A Transactional channel configuration overrides opt-outs. Sending a promotion through one mails people who said no. If it sells, it is Marketing.

Deliverability is a design constraint



KEY IDEA

Mailbox providers judge a sender's reputation, which is earned slowly and lost quickly. One bad month can blacklist a domain.

No, and here is the proof

The rival's failure	Bloom's guardrail
Too many emails	Two a week, in the global rule set
Messages at night	Quiet hours, customer's time zone
Bounces and spam complaints	The suppression list
Mailing people who said no	Consent and the One click Opt-out link
Promotions as service mail	Marketing configuration only

KEY IDEA

By evening Divya answered Anjali: no, and here is where each guardrail lives. Every way the rival failed has a named control at Bloom.

Interview corner

- Per-journey capping is not frequency capping
- Rule: 2 marketing emails per profile per week
- Lives in the global rule set, or selected everywhere
- A Draft rule set protects nobody
- Resets in UTC; applies to proofs

KEY IDEA

Frequency capping applied per journey is not frequency capping.

Recap, your question, and the next mystery

- Cap per person: 2 marketing emails a week
- Global rule set, or active and selected everywhere
- Quiet hours on the customer's clock: queue or discard
- Suppression is deliverability; unsubscribe is consent
- Next: why didn't it send?

KEY IDEA

Cap per person where it covers everything; quiet hours on the customer's clock; suppression is not consent. Next: why didn't it send?